one.

13

July 26, 1953, was not only our eleventh wedding anniversary, it was also the eleventh wedding anniversary of Bemie and Ruth Pitt, who were now as well ensconced in the department as we were. We joined forces and celebrated the combined anniversary at a steak house in Framingham.

What we did not know was that on that very day someone named Fidel Castro attempted a coup in Cuba and failed to overthrow the dictator, Batista. Castro began a guerrilla movement, however, which he called "the Twenty-sixth of July Movement" and he kept it going in eastern mountains until it was successful.

Also on that day, a truce was finally signed in Korea, ending the Korean War, in stalemate, after three years and a month.

Scott Meredith wrote me a letter as soon as he heard of Fred's failure and offered to take me on, but for the second time I refused politely. Forry Ackerman also wrote to make a similar offer, and I refused thai too.

I think everyone waited for me to get either tired or disillusioned with representing myself, but they had a long wait. I never got either tired or disillusioned.

Fortunately, the passing of Fred's agency in no way affected the even tenor of my writing, and we celebrated David's second birthday on August 20 pleasantly and calmly.

*5

The eleventh World Science Fiction Convention was being held in Philadelphia over the Labor Day weekend, and on Thursday, Sep-

tember 3, 1953, we went to New York, where we left David, then on to-Philadelphia on the fourth. The convention was beginning and I met Randall Garrett, James Gunn, and Philip Farmer, three new authors I had not met before.

Garrett was an incredibly intelligent fellow who bubbled over constantly. It was as though his tap had been turned full-on and nailed there. Mine seemed to be turned on also, I admit, but I could always shut down if I had to. He,